“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 9

The Pilgrimage to the Holy Places of the South

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

1 The people of the South were like elephants seized by the crocodiles of various doctrines. Gaura freed them with the disc of His mercy and made them Vaiṣṇavas.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![2]

3 The Lord’s journey to the south was most extraordinary: He visited thousands upon thousands of holy places.

4 By touching all those holy places He made them great holy places, and under that pretext He delivered the people of that land.

5 I cannot set those holy places in order, for His journey to them went right and left, back and forth.[3]

6 Therefore I simply list their names; I cannot describe them in their proper sequence.

7–8 As before, all who saw Him on the road, and all the people of every village He came to, became Vaiṣṇavas and chanted “Kṛṣṇa” and “Hari.” They in turn delivered other villages, making their people Vaiṣṇavas.

9 The people of the South were of many kinds: some were *jñānīs*, some were *karmīs*, and the unbelievers were countless.[4]

10 Such was the power of the Lord’s *darśana* that all those people gave up their own doctrines and became Vaiṣṇavas.

11 The Vaiṣṇavas there all worshipped Rāma: some were Tattvavādīs, and some were Śrī Vaiṣṇavas.

12 Upon seeing Mahāprabhu, all those Vaiṣṇavas became worshippers of Kṛṣṇa and took up the name of Kṛṣṇa.

13 “Rāma! Rāghava! Rāma! Rāghava! Rāma! Rāghava! Save me! Kṛṣṇa! Keśava! Kṛṣṇa! Keśava! Kṛṣṇa! Keśava! Protect me!”

14 Reciting this verse along the way, the Lord journeyed on. He came to Gautamī-gaṅgā and bathed in the Gaṅgā there.

15 He went to Mallikārjuna-tīrtha and saw Maheśa (Śiva). There He made all the people take the name of Kṛṣṇa.

16 He had *darśana* of Mahādeva, the servant of Rāma, and then went to Ahovala-nṛsiṁha.

17 Seeing Nṛsiṁha, He offered Him obeisances and prayers. Then He went to Siddhavaṭa, where Sītā’s Lord abides in His Deity form.

18 Seeing Raghunātha, He offered obeisances and prayers. There a brāhmaṇa invited the Lord to take His meal.

19 That brāhmaṇa chanted the name of Rāma constantly. Apart from "Rāma, Rāma," he spoke no other word.

20 Gaurahari stayed in his house that day and accepted His meal there. Then, after blessing him, He went on.

21 At Skanda-kṣetra He had darśana of Skanda. Then He came to Trimaṭha and saw Trivikrama there.

22 He came back to Siddhavaṭa, to the house of that brāhmaṇa, and now the brāhmaṇa was constantly chanting the name of Kṛṣṇa.

23 After taking His meal, Mahāprabhu asked him, "Tell Me, brāhmaṇa, what state has come over you?

24 Before, you chanted the name of Rāma constantly. Why do you now constantly chant the name of Kṛṣṇa?"

25 The brāhmaṇa said, "This is by the power of seeing You. When I saw You, the nature I had from birth left me.

26 From childhood I have chanted the name of Rāma. But when I saw You, the name of Kṛṣṇa came to me — just once.

27 Since then the name of Kṛṣṇa has dwelt on my tongue: it is Kṛṣṇa's name that now comes forth, and the name of Rāma has gone far away.

28 From childhood I have had one habit: I collect what the scriptures say about the glory of the holy name.

29 "The yogīs delight (*ramante*) in the Infinite, in true bliss, in the spiritual Self; therefore the Supreme Brahman is called 'Rāma.' " (Padma Purāṇa, Śrī Rāmacandra's Śata-nāma-stotra, 8)[5]

30 “The sound ‘kṛṣ’ denotes being, and ‘ṇa’ denotes bliss. Their union, the Supreme Brahman, is called ‘Kṛṣṇa.’ ” (Mahābhārata, Udyoga-parva, 71.4)[6]

31 Both names belong to the Supreme Brahman and so are equal. But in the scriptures I found a further distinction.

32 “O fair-faced one, chanting ‘Rāma, Rāma, Rāma,’ I take delight in the enchanting Rāma. The name of Rāma is equal to the thousand names (of Viṣṇu).” (Padma Purāṇa, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 72.335)

33 “The result obtained by reciting the thousand holy names (of Viṣṇu) three times is given by a single utterance of one name of Kṛṣṇa.” (Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa)

34 This statement shows the boundless glory of the name of Kṛṣṇa. Still I could not chant it; hear the reason.

35 Rāma is my chosen Deity, and I found happiness in His name; finding that happiness, I sang the name of Rāma night and day.

36 When the name of Kṛṣṇa came to me at the sight of You, its glory took hold of my heart.

37 I have clearly understood that You are that very Kṛṣṇa.” Saying this, the brāhmaṇa fell at the Lord’s feet.

38 After showing him mercy, the Lord set out the next day. He came to Vṛddhakāśī and had darśana of Śiva.

39 Going on from there, He came to a village where there was a community of brāhmaṇas, and He rested there.

40 Drawn by the Lord's power, people came to see Him — hundreds of thousands, millions, beyond counting.

41 Seeing the Lord's beauty and His absorption in love, everyone said "Kṛṣṇa," and the whole land became Vaiṣṇava.

42 There were logicians and Mīmāṁsakas, all the Māyāvādīs, and followers of Sāṅkhya and Pātañjala (yoga), of the smṛtis, the Purāṇas and the Āgamas.[7]

43 All of them were fierce in upholding their own scriptures, but the Lord exposed the faults of every doctrine and broke them to pieces.

44 Everywhere the Lord established the Vaiṣṇava siddhānta, and no one could refute His conclusions.

45 Defeated again and again, they came over to the Lord's teaching, and in this way He made the South Vaiṣṇava.

46 Hearing of His learning, all the unbelievers came; full of pride, they brought their disciples with them.

47 A Buddhist ācārya, a great scholar of his own nine principles, began to argue for them insistently before the Lord.

48 Although the Buddhists are not to be spoken with, and it is improper even to look at them, the Lord spoke in order to break their pride.[8]

49 The Buddhist scriptures, with their "nine principles," rest on logic, so the Lord refuted them by logic alone, and they could not uphold them.[910]

50 The Buddhist ācārya put forward all nine propositions, and the Lord broke them to pieces with firm reasoning and logic.

51 All the scholar-philosophers were defeated. People laughed, and the Buddhists felt shame and fear.

52 Knowing the Lord to be a Vaiṣṇava, the Buddhists went home. Then all of them gathered and made an evil plot.

53 They filled a plate with impure food and brought it before the Lord, calling it “mahā-prasāda.”

54 Just then a huge bird came, took the plate with the food in its beak and carried it off.

55 The impure food rained down on the Buddhists, and the plate came down with a clang on the head of the Buddhist ācārya.

56 The plate struck edgewise and gashed his head, and the ācārya fell to the ground unconscious.

57 All the disciples cried out in lamentation and wept. They came and took shelter at the Lord’s feet:

58 “You are the Lord Himself. Forgive our offence. Bring our guru back to life — be merciful!”

59 The Lord said, “All of you say ‘Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa, Hari!’ Say the name of Kṛṣṇa loudly into your guru’s ear.

60 Then your guru will regain consciousness.” All the Buddhists together performed the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa’s name.

61 All of them said “Kṛṣṇa! Rāma! Hari!” into their guru’s ear. Regaining consciousness, the ācārya said, “Hari! Hari!”

62 Saying “Kṛṣṇa,” the ācārya humbly prayed to the Lord. Seeing this, all the people were amazed.

63 Having played in this way, the son of Śacī disappeared, and no one could see Him.

64 Mahāprabhu journeyed on to Tripati and Trimalla. After seeing the four-armed Deity, He went on to Veṅkaṭādri.

65 Coming to Tripati, He had darśana of Śrī Rāma, and before Raghunātha He offered obeisances and prayers.

66 Amazing all the people by His influence, the all-merciful Lord came to Pānā-nṛsiṁha.

67 Absorbed in love, He offered obeisances and prayers to Nṛsiṁha, and the people were astonished at the Lord’s influence.

68 Coming to Śiva-kāñcī, He had darśana of Śiva, and by His influence He made all the Śaivas Vaiṣṇavas.

69 Coming to Viṣṇu-kāñcī, He saw Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa, bowed down and offered many prayers.

70 Absorbed in love, He danced and sang a great deal. He stayed there two days and made the people devotees of Kṛṣṇa.

71 After seeing Trimalaya, He went to Trikālahastī. There He saw Mahādeva and bowed down to him.

72 At Pakṣī-tīrtha He had darśana of Śiva, and then He went to Vṛddhakola-tīrtha.

73 There He saw Śveta-varāha and bowed down to Him. Then Gaurahari went to the place of Śiva Pītāmbara.

74 After seeing the goddess Śiyālī-bhairavī, the son of Śacī came to the bank of the Kāverī.[11]

75 At Go-samāja He saw Śiva, and then He came to Vedāvana. There He saw Mahādeva and paid him homage.

76 Seeing Śiva Amṛta-liṅga, He paid him homage. In all the temples of Śiva, the Śaivas became Vaiṣṇavas.

77 Coming to Devasthāna, He had darśana of Viṣṇu, and there He was constantly in discussion with the Śrī Vaiṣṇavas.

78 At Kumbhakarṇa-kapāla the beautiful Gaurāṅga saw the lake, and at Śiva-kṣetra He saw Śiva.

79 At Pāpanāśana He had darśana of Viṣṇu, and then He went to Śrī Raṅga-kṣetra.

80 He bathed in the Kāverī and saw Raṅganātha. Offering prayers and obeisances, He felt His purpose fulfilled.

81 Absorbed in love, He sang and danced a great deal, and all the people who saw it were amazed.

82 A Śrī Vaiṣṇava named Veṅkaṭa Bhaṭṭa respectfully invited the Lord.

83 He brought the Lord to his house and washed His feet, and he and his whole family drank that water.

84 After serving Him a meal, he made a request: “O Lord, the Cāturmāsya is at hand.

85 Be merciful and stay in my house for Cāturmāsya. Speak about Kṛṣṇa and mercifully deliver me.”

86 The Lord stayed in his house, relishing talks about Kṛṣṇa, and happily spent the four months with the Bhaṭṭa.

87 Every day He bathed in the Kāverī, had darśana of Śrī Raṅga and danced, absorbed in love.

88 All the people came to see His beauty and His absorption in love; they saw Him, and their sorrow and grief were gone.

89 Hundreds of thousands of people came from various lands, and on seeing the Lord all of them chanted the name of Kṛṣṇa.

90 No one spoke anything but the name of Kṛṣṇa. Everyone became a devotee of Kṛṣṇa, and the people were amazed.

91 All the Vaiṣṇava brāhmaṇas living in Śrī Raṅga-kṣetra invited Him, each for one day.

92 With one host each day, the Cāturmāsya came to an end, and some brāhmaṇas never had the chance to serve Him a meal.

93 In that holy place lived a Vaiṣṇava brāhmaṇa who would come to the temple and recite the Gītā.

94 He read all eighteen chapters, overwhelmed with bliss; but his reading was faulty, and people laughed at him.

95 Some laughed and some censured him, but he paid no heed. Absorbed, he read the Gītā with a joyful heart.

96 As long as he read, his hair stood on end, and he shed tears, trembled and perspired. Seeing this, Mahāprabhu was delighted.

97 Mahāprabhu asked him, “Listen, good sir: what meaning do you understand that gives you such happiness?”

98 The brāhmaṇa said, “I am a fool and do not know the meaning of the words. Correctly or incorrectly, I read the Gītā in obedience to my guru’s order.

99 On Arjuna’s chariot Kṛṣṇa holds the reins. He is seated there, a dark and beautiful form.

100 He gives Arjuna counsel for his good, and as I see Him, I am overwhelmed with bliss.

101 As long as I read, I see Him. That is why my mind will not give up reading the Gītā.”

102 The Lord said, “You alone are truly qualified to read the Gītā; you know the essence of its meaning.”

103 Saying this, the Lord embraced the brāhmaṇa, and the brāhmaṇa clasped the Lord’s feet and wept.

104 “Seeing You, I am twice as happy as that. It seems to me that You are that very Kṛṣṇa.”

105 His mind had become pure through Kṛṣṇa's manifestation in his heart; therefore he understood the whole truth about the Lord.

106 Then Mahāprabhu instructed him: "Do not reveal this matter to anyone."

107 That brāhmaṇa became a great devotee of Mahāprabhu, and for four months he never left the Lord's company.

108 In this way Gauracandra lived in the Bhaṭṭa's house, constantly enjoying the bliss of talks about Kṛṣṇa with him.

109 The Bhaṭṭa, a Śrī Vaiṣṇava, served Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa, and seeing his devotion, the Lord was pleased at heart.

110 Being constantly together, they came to feel like friends, and, as friends do, the two joked and teased each other.

111 The Lord said, "Bhaṭṭa, your goddess Lakṣmī dwells on the chest of her husband; she is the crown jewel of chaste women.

112 But My Lord Kṛṣṇa is a cowherd who tends cows. Why should a chaste lady desire His company?

113 For this she gave up her pleasures, and for a long time she kept vows and rules and performed boundless austerities.

114 "O Lord, we do not know by what merit this one has gained the right to touch the dust of Your feet. Longing for it, Śrī, the best of women, renounced all desires and practised austerities, keeping her vows for a very long time." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.16.36)

115 The Bhaṭṭa said, “Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa are one and the same Person; but in Kṛṣṇa there is more of pastime, of artfulness and the like.[12]

116 His touch does not violate her chastity. Lakṣmī desires Kṛṣṇa’s company out of playful curiosity.

117 “Although, by the conclusion of the scriptures (*siddhānta*), the Lord of Śrī and Kṛṣṇa are one in essence, in rasa the form of Kṛṣṇa excels: such is the nature of rasa.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.59)[13]

118 In Kṛṣṇa’s company her vow of chastity is not broken; rather she gains something more — the rāsa dance.

119 If the playful Lakṣmī longs for Kṛṣṇa, what fault is there in that? Why do You laugh at it?”

120 The Lord said, “I know there is no fault in it. But I hear from the scriptures that Lakṣmī did not attain the rāsa dance.

121 “At the festival of the rāsa dance He embraced the beautiful women of Vraja around their necks with His arms, and they attained their heart’s desire. Such favour was not granted even to Śrī, who is wholly devoted to Him, nor to the celestial women, fragrant and radiant like lotuses — what then of others?” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.47.60)

122 Why did Lakṣmī not attain it? What is the reason? And how did the Śrutis attain Kṛṣṇa by performing austerities?

123 “That which the sages worship in the heart, having restrained breath, mind and senses in firm yoga, Your enemies attained simply by remembering You. The women whose minds were fixed on Your arms, like the coils of the king of serpents, attained the nectar of Your lotus feet; and

we too, having become like them and following their mood, taste that nectar." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.87.23)

124 The Śrutis attained it, but Lakṣmī did not — what is the reason?" The Bhaṭṭa said, "My mind cannot enter into this.

125 I am a jīva of small intelligence, unsteady by nature, while the Lord's pastimes are as deep as ten million oceans.

126 You are that very Kṛṣṇa, and You know Your own deeds. Only one to whom You reveal it knows the secret of Your pastimes."

127 The Lord said, "Kṛṣṇa has one living characteristic, ever active: by His own sweetness He attracts every heart.

128 His feet are attained by following the feelings of the people of Vraja, and the people of Vraja do not know Him as the Lord.

129 One, regarding Him as her son, ties Him to a mortar; another, regarding Him as a friend, defeats Him and climbs onto His shoulders.

130 The people of Vraja know Him as the son of the king of Vraja; no thought of His majesty enters into their relationship with Him.

131 Whoever worships in the mood of the people of Vraja attains in Vraja the son of the king of Vraja in His pure form.

132 "This Bhagavān, the son of the gopī, is not so easily attained by the embodied, nor by the jñānīs, nor by those who have realized the self, as He is by those who have devotion." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.9.21)

133 The Śrutis became followers of the gopīs and worshipped the son of the queen of Vraja, taking on the mood of the gopīs.[14]

134 When in Vraja they obtained the bodies of gopīs, outwardly and inwardly, in those bodies they enjoyed the rāsa dance with Kṛṣṇa.

135 Kṛṣṇa belongs to the cowherd folk, and the gopīs are His beloveds. Kṛṣṇa does not accept a goddess or any other woman.

136 Lakṣmī desires Kṛṣṇa's company in that same body of hers; she did not worship Him as a follower of the gopīs.

137 In any other body one does not attain the rāsa play. That is why Vedavyāsa spoke the verse beginning "nāyaṁ."

138 Before this, there was a proud conviction in the Bhaṭṭa's mind that Śrī Nārāyaṇa is Svayam Bhagavān,

139 and that worship of Him is of the highest order, so the worship of the Śrī Vaiṣṇavas is the highest of all.

140 To break this pride of his, the Lord spoke all these words in jest.

141 The Lord said, "Bhaṭṭa, do not doubt it: it is certain that Kṛṣṇa is Svayam Bhagavān.

142 Śrī Nārāyaṇa is Kṛṣṇa's form for pastimes (vilāsa-mūrti); that is why He captivates the minds of Lakṣmī and others.

143 "All these (avatāras) are portions (*aṁśa*) and parts of portions (*kalā*) of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Age after age They bring happiness to the world when it is troubled by the enemies of Indra." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.28)[15]

144 Kṛṣṇa has extraordinary qualities beyond Nārāyaṇa's; that is why Lakṣmī constantly thirsts for Kṛṣṇa.

145 The very verse you recited is the proof: it shows that Kṛṣṇa is Svayam Bhagavān.

146 “Although, by the conclusion of the scriptures (*siddhānta*), the Lord of Śrī and Kṛṣṇa are one in essence, in rasa the form of Kṛṣṇa excels: such is the nature of rasa.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.59)[16]

147 Kṛṣṇa, Svayam Bhagavān, captivates the mind of Lakṣmī, but Nārāyaṇa cannot captivate the minds of the gopīs.

148 What to speak of Nārāyaṇa? Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself becomes Nārāyaṇa to make the gopīs laugh.

149 He shows a four-armed form before the gopīs, but the gopīs feel no loving attachment for that “Kṛṣṇa.”

150 “What wise man can fathom the ways of the gopīs’ love for the son of the cowherd king — a love that moves on a path beyond comprehension? For even when He reveals a form of Viṣṇu, wondrous in its splendour, with four victorious arms, their love, alas, shrinks back.” (Lalita-mādhava, 6.14)[17]

151 Speaking thus, the Lord crushed his pride. Then, to make him happy, He turned the argument around and said:

152 “Do not be sad, Bhaṭṭa; I was only joking. Now hear the conclusion of the scriptures on which the Vaiṣṇavas’ faith rests.

153 Just as Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa are one and the same Person, so there is no difference between the gopīs and Lakṣmī: they are one in form.

154 One and the same form assumes various appearances. Know the truth: there is no difference between the gopīs and Lakṣmī.

155 Through the gopīs, Lakṣmī tastes the joy of Kṛṣṇa's company. To see any difference in Their Godhood is an offence.

156 The Lord is one; according to each devotee's meditation, one and the same form assumes various appearances.

157 "As a gem joined with blue, yellow and other colours appears different, so Acyuta takes different forms according to the meditation of the worshipper." (Śrī Nārada-pañcarātra)

158 The Bhaṭṭa said, "How far apart we are: I, a fallen jīva, and You, that very Kṛṣṇa, the Lord Himself!

159 I know nothing of the Lord's fathomless pastimes. Whatever You say, I accept as the truth.

160 Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa have shown me Their full mercy; by Their mercy I have been granted the sight of Your feet.

161 In Your mercy You have told me of the greatness of Kṛṣṇa, whose beauty, qualities and majesty no one can measure.

162 Now I have understood that devotion to Kṛṣṇa is above all. You have fulfilled my life by mercifully telling me this."

163 Saying this, the Bhaṭṭa fell at the Lord's feet, and the Lord mercifully embraced him.

164 When the Cāturmāsya was over, the Lord took the Bhaṭṭa's leave, saw Śrī Raṅga and went on to the south.

165 The Bhaṭṭa went along with Him and would not go home; only with great effort did the Lord send him back.

166 In separation from the Lord, the Bhaṭṭa fell unconscious. Such are the playful pastimes of Śacī's son.

167 Gaurahari went on and came to Ṛṣabha hill. There He saw Nārāyaṇa and offered obeisances and prayers.

168 Paramānanda Purī was staying there for the four months. Hearing this, Mahāprabhu went to Purī Gosāñi.

169 The Lord bowed at the feet of Purī Gosāñi, and Purī Gosāñi lovingly embraced Him.

170 For three days the two of them stayed together in that brāhmaṇa's house, rejoicing in loving talks about Kṛṣṇa.

171 Purī Gosāñi said, "I shall go to Puruṣottama. After seeing Puruṣottama, I shall go to Gauḍa to bathe in the Gaṅgā."

172 The Lord said, "Please come back to Nīlācala. I shall return from Setubandha before long.

173 I wish to stay in your company, so be kind to Me and come to Nīlācala."

174 Having said this and taken his leave, the Lord went on to the south in great joy.

175 Paramānanda Purī then set out for Nīlācala, and Mahāprabhu went on and came to Śrī Śaila.

176 Śiva and Durgā lived there in the guise of a brāhmaṇa couple. Seeing Mahāprabhu, both were overjoyed.

177 They invited Him and served Him meals for three days, and the two sat in seclusion and spoke of confidential matters.

178 After holding spiritual discussions with him, Mahāprabhu took his leave and came to Kāmakoṣṭhī-purī.

179 From Kāmakoṣṭhī He came to Southern Mathurā, and there He met a brāhmaṇa.

180 That brāhmaṇa invited Mahāprabhu. He was a devotee of Rāma, a renounced great soul.

181 After bathing in the Kṛtamālā, the Lord came to his house. But what meal could the brāhmaṇa serve? He had not cooked.

182 Mahāprabhu said to him, “Listen, good sir: it is already midday. Why has nothing been cooked?”

183 The brāhmaṇa said, “O Lord, I live in the forest, and at present the things needed for cooking are not to be had here.

184 Lakṣmaṇa will bring wild greens, fruits and roots, and then Sītā will do the cooking.”

185 The Lord was pleased to hear of his way of worship, and the brāhmaṇa cooked in great haste.

186 The Lord took His meal in the third *prahara* of the day, after noon, but the brāhmaṇa, dejected, went on fasting.

187 The Lord said, “Brāhmaṇa, why are you fasting? Why such sorrow, why such despair?”

188 The brāhmaṇa said, “I have no more use for my life. I shall enter fire or water and give it up.

189 Sītā, our Queen, is Mahā-Lakṣmī, the mother of the world — and a rākṣasa touched her! This I hear with my own ears.

190 It is not fitting for me to keep this body any longer. My body burns with this grief, yet life does not leave it.”

191 The Lord said, “Do not think this way any more. You are a paṇḍita — why do you not consider the matter?

192 Sītā, the beloved of the Lord, is a form of spirit and bliss; material senses have no power even to see her.

193 Touching her is out of the question — they cannot even see her. What Rāvaṇa carried off was only an illusory likeness of Sītā.

194 The moment Rāvaṇa came, Sītā disappeared and sent a *māyā-Sītā* before him.

195 A transcendental reality is never within the range of the material: the Vedas and Purāṇas declare this again and again.[18]

196 Have faith in My words, and never again let such wrong thoughts enter your mind.”

197 The brāhmaṇa came to believe the Lord’s words. He ate, and his hope of life returned.

198 Having comforted him, the Lord went on. After bathing in the Kṛtamālā, He came to Durvaśana.[19]

199 In Durvaśana He had *darśana* of Raghunātha, and on the Mahendra hill He offered homage to Paraśurāma.

200 Coming to Setubandha, He bathed at Dhanus-tīrtha; then He saw Rāmeśvara and rested there.

201 There, in an assembly of brāhmaṇas, He listened to the *Kūrma Purāṇa*, and in the course of it came the story of the chaste wife.[20]

202 The daughter of Janaka, the crown jewel of chaste wives, is Sītā, the mother of the world and the wife of Rāma.

203 When Sītā saw Rāvaṇa, she took shelter of Agni, and Agni hid her from Rāvaṇa.

204 Hearing in the story that Rāvaṇa had carried off a "*māyā-Sītā*," Mahāprabhu rejoiced at heart.

205 Agni took Sītā and kept her with Pārvatī, and deceived Rāvaṇa by giving him a "*māyā-Sītā*."

206 When Raghunātha came and slew Rāvaṇa, He had Sītā brought to undergo the ordeal by fire.

207 Then the *māyā-Sītā* vanished in the fire, and Agni brought the real Sītā and gave her back in Rāma's presence.[21]

208 Hearing these conclusions, the Lord was overjoyed. He asked the brāhmaṇas for that leaf and took it.

209 He had the leaf copied and the new copy placed in the book, and He asked for the old leaf to take with Him as proof.[22]

210 Taking the leaf, He came back to Southern Mathurā and gave it to the brāhmaṇa Rāmadāsa.

211 “Propitiated by Sītā, Agni produced a shadow Sītā. The ten-headed Rāvaṇa carried her off, while Sītā herself went to the abode of Agni.” (Kūrma Purāṇa)

212 “At the time of the ordeal the shadow Sītā entered the fire, and Agni brought Sītā and delivered her before Rāma.” (Kūrma Purāṇa)

213 Receiving the leaf, the brāhmaṇa was overjoyed. He clasped the Lord’s feet and wept.

214 The brāhmaṇa said, “You are Śrī Raghunandana Himself, and You have given me *darśana* in the garb of a sannyāsī.

215 You have delivered me from great sorrow. Please accept a meal in my house today.

216 That day, in my grief, I did not give You a proper meal; by my good fortune I have seen You once again.”

217 Saying this, the brāhmaṇa happily cooked and served the Lord a splendid meal.

218 Gaurahari stayed there that night, showing him mercy, and then went to the Tāmraparṇī in the Pāṇḍya country.

219 He bathed in the Tāmraparṇī, and on its bank He joyfully went about seeing Naya Tripati, the nine Tripatis.

220 At the holy place of Ciyaḍatalā He saw Śrī Rāma and Lakṣmaṇa, and coming to Tilakāñcī, He had *darśana* of Śiva.

221 At Gajendra-mokṣaṇa-tīrtha He saw the Deity of Viṣṇu, and coming to Pānāgaḍi-tīrtha, He saw the Lord of Sītā.

222 Coming to Cāmtāpura, He saw Śrī Rāma and Lakṣmaṇa; coming to Śrī Vaikuṇṭha, He had *darśana* of Viṣṇu.

223 On the Malaya hill He offered homage to Agastya, and there He had *darśana* of Kanyākumārī.

224 Having seen Śrī Rāma at Āmlitalā, Gaurahari came to the Mallāra country, where the Bhaṭṭathāris live.[23]

225 After seeing Tamāla-kārttika He came to Vetāpani; there He saw Raghunātha and spent the night.

226 The brāhmaṇa Kṛṣṇadāsa, who was travelling with the Lord, met the Bhaṭṭathāris there.

227 By showing him women and wealth they aroused his greed and robbed that good and simple brāhmaṇa of his reason.

228 Rising in the morning, the brāhmaṇa went to the Bhaṭṭathāris' dwelling, and the Lord quickly came there in search of him.

229 Coming there, He said to all the Bhaṭṭathāris, "Why are you keeping My brāhmaṇa?

230 See, I am a sannyāsī, and you too are sannyāsīs. Yet you give Me pain — I cannot call this justice on your part."

231 Hearing this, all the Bhaṭṭathāris rose up with weapons and came running at Him from all sides to kill Him.

232 Their weapons fell from their hands upon their own bodies. Cut to pieces, the Bhaṭṭathāris fled in all directions.

233 A great wailing arose in the Bhaṭṭathāris' dwelling, and the Lord seized the brāhmaṇa by the hair and led him away.

234 That same day He came to the bank of the Payasvinī, bathed, and went to the temple of Ādi-keśava.

235 Seeing Keśava, He was overwhelmed with love and offered many obeisances and prayers, dancing and singing.

236 Seeing His love, the people were utterly amazed, and everyone honoured the Lord in the highest way.

237 There He held discussions with great devotees, and there He found the manuscript of the chapter of the *Brahma-saṁhitā*.[24]

238 Finding the manuscript, the Lord felt boundless joy, and the transformations of ecstasy appeared in Him — trembling, tears, perspiration, stupor and horripilation.

239 No scripture of conclusive truth equals the *Brahma-saṁhitā*: it is the supreme source of the knowledge of Govinda's glory.

240 In few words it sets forth boundless conclusions; among all the Vaiṣṇava scriptures it is the very essence.

241 With great care He had the manuscript copied and took it with Him, and joyfully came to Ananta-padmanābha.

242 For two days He had *darśana* of Padmanābha, and then joyfully came to see Śrī Janārdana.

243 For two days He sang and danced there in *kīrtana*; then, coming to the Payasvinī, He saw Śaṅkara-nārāyaṇa.

244 He came to the Śṛṅgeri Maṭha, the seat of Śaṅkarācārya; then He saw Matsya-tīrtha and bathed in the Tuṅgabhadrā.

245 He came to the seat of Madhvācārya, where the Tattvavādīs live, and seeing "Kṛṣṇa" in Uḍupī, He became mad with love.

246 He saw the supremely enchanting "Nartaka-gopāla," the dancing Gopāla, who had come to Madhvācārya after appearing to him in a dream.

247 Lying in a boat beneath a load of *gopī-candana*, He somehow came to Madhvācārya.

248 Madhvācārya brought Him and installed Him, and to this day the Tattvavādīs serve Him.

249 Seeing the Deity of Kṛṣṇa, the Lord felt great happiness, and in ecstatic love He danced and sang at length.

250 The Tattvavādīs took the Lord for a "Māyāvādī," and at their first meeting they did not speak to Him.

251 Later, seeing His ecstatic love, they were amazed, and regarding Him as a Vaiṣṇava, they honoured Him greatly.

252 Knowing that in their hearts they all took pride in their "Vaiṣṇavism," Gauramaṇi, the jewel Gaura, smiled slightly and spoke.

253 Aware of the pride in their hearts, Gauracandra began a discussion with them all.

254 The ācārya of the Tattvavādīs was learned in all the scriptures, and the Lord, as if He were humble, put a question to him:[25]

255 “I do not properly understand the goal (*sādhya*) and the means (*sādhana*). Please tell Me which goal and which means are the highest.”

256 The ācārya said, “To follow the duties of *varṇa* and *āśrama* and offer them to Kṛṣṇa — this is the best ‘means’ for a devotee of Kṛṣṇa.[26]

257 To attain the five kinds of liberation and go to Vaikuṇṭha is the highest ‘goal’ — so the scriptures determine.”

258 The Lord said, “The scriptures declare that hearing and chanting are the ‘supreme means’ to the fruit of loving service to Kṛṣṇa.

259–260 “Hearing about Viṣṇu and chanting His glories, remembering Him, serving His feet, worshipping Him, offering Him prayers, serving Him as His servant, befriending Him and offering Him one’s whole self — if a person offers devotion to Viṣṇu with these nine marks and performs it directly for the Lord, I consider that the highest learning.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 7.5.23–24)[27]

261 From hearing and chanting arises love (*premā*) for Kṛṣṇa. That is the fifth goal of life, the furthest limit of all human goals.

262 “One who has taken this vow, chanting the names of his beloved Lord, finds love awakening within him; his heart melts, and, heedless of the world, he laughs aloud, weeps, cries out, sings and dances like a madman.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.40)[28][29]

263 All the scriptures censure *karma* and enjoin its renunciation: loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*) to Kṛṣṇa never arises from *karma*.

264 “Knowing in this way their merits and faults, he who gives up all his duties, even those I Myself have enjoined, and worships Me — he is the best of the saintly.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.11.32)[3031]

265 “Give up all *dharmas* and take shelter of Me alone. I shall free you from all sins; do not grieve.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 18.66)[32]

266 “One should go on performing one’s prescribed duties only so long as one has not grown weary of them, or so long as faith has not been born in hearing about Me and the like.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.20.9)[33]

267 The devotees reject the five kinds of liberation; they deem “liberation” worthless and look upon it as no better than hell.

268 “My devotees accept nothing but service to Me — not even when they are offered residence in My world, opulence equal to Mine, nearness to Me, a form like Mine, or even oneness with Me.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.13)[3435]

269 “The king did not desire land, sons, kinsmen, wealth and wife, so hard to give up, nor even Śrī, the goddess of fortune, whose kind glance the best of the gods long for. This is fitting for great souls whose minds are devoted to the service of Kṛṣṇa, the foe of Madhu: for them even liberation is worthless.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 5.14.44)[36]

270 “Those who are devoted to Nārāyaṇa fear nothing from any quarter; in heaven, in liberation and even in hell they see the same worth.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 6.17.28)[37]

271 Liberation and *karma* — these two things the devotees give up, yet you establish those very two as the ‘goal’ and the ‘means.’

272 Seeing that I am a sannyāsī, you are deceiving Me, and so you have not told Me the true nature of the goal and the means."

273 Hearing this, the ācārya of the Tattvavādīs was ashamed at heart, and seeing the Lord's Vaiṣṇava spirit, he was astonished.[38]

274 The ācārya said, "What You say is true; in all the scriptures this is the firm conclusion of the Vaiṣṇavas.

275 Yet Madhvācārya laid down this rule, and because of our connection with his *sampradāya* we all follow it."

276 The Lord said, "The *karmī* and the *jñānī* are both devoid of devotion, and in your *sampradāya* I see the signs of both.

277 I see only one merit in your *sampradāya*: you firmly hold that the Lord's form is real (*satya-vigraha*)."[39]

278 Having thus crushed the ācārya's pride, Śrī Gaurahari then came to Phalgu-tīrtha.[40]

279 At Tritakūpa He had *darśana* of Viśālākṣī, and then the son of Śacī came to Pañcāpsarā-tīrtha.

280 After seeing Śiva in Gokarṇa He came to Dvaipāyani, and then the crown jewel of sannyāsīs came to the holy place of Sūrpāraka.

281 In Kolāpura He saw Lakṣmī and then Kṣīra-bhagavatī; He saw Lāṅga-gaṇeśa and then Cora-pārvatī.

282 From there Gauracandra came to Pāṇḍarapura, and seeing Viṭhṭhala Ṭhākura, He was filled with bliss.

283 In ecstatic love He sang and danced at length in *kīrtana*, and a brāhmaṇa there invited Him.

284 With great affection the brāhmaṇa served the Lord a meal, and after the meal the Lord received some good news there.

285 A disciple of Mādhava Purī (Mādhavendra Purī) named Śrī Raṅga Purī was staying in a brāhmaṇa's house in that village.

286 Hearing this, the Lord set out to see him, and He found him sitting in the brāhmaṇa's house.

287 In ecstatic love He offered him prostrate obeisances; tears, horripilation and trembling came over Him, and sweat streamed from all His limbs.

288 Seeing this, Śrī Raṅga Purī was amazed at heart, and he said, "Rise, Śrīpāda!

289 Śrīpāda, You must have a connection with my Gosāñi, Mādhavendra Purī; without it there is not even a trace of such love anywhere."[41]

290 Saying this, he raised the Lord and embraced Him, and clasping each other around the neck, they both wept.

291 After a while they came out of their ecstasy and grew calm, and the Lord told him of His connection with Īśvara Purī.

292 A wondrous flood of love welled up in them both. Showing each other respect, they sat down together in bliss.

293 Night and day the two of them spoke about Kṛṣṇa, and in this way they spent five or seven days.

294 Out of curiosity Purī asked Him where He was born, and the Lord playfully answered, “A place called Navadvīpa.”

295 Śrī Raṅga Purī, the disciple of Śrī Mādhava Purī, had once come to the town of Nadīyā.

296 He recalled the meal he had taken in the house of Jagannātha Miśra and the wonderful curry of banana flowers he had eaten there.

297 “Jagannātha’s wife is a great and chaste lady; in her motherly love she is like the mother of the world.

298 In all the three worlds no one equals her skill in cooking, and when she feeds sannyāsīs she loves them as her own sons.

299 One worthy son of hers took *sannyāsa*. His name was Śaṅkarāraṇya, and he was young.

300 At this holy place Śaṅkarāraṇya attained perfection (*siddhi*).” This is what Śrī Raṅga Purī told Him in the course of their talk.[42]

301 The Lord said, “In My former *āśrama* he was My brother, and Jagannātha Miśra was My father.”

302 When the two had thus talked together of their Beloved (*iṣṭa-goṣṭhī*), Śrī Raṅga Purī set out to see Dvārakā.

303 The brāhmaṇa kept the Lord there for four days, and the Lord bathed in the river Bhīmā and had *darśana* of Viṭhṭhala.

304 Then Mahāprabhu came to the bank of the Kṛṣṇaveṇvā, and there He saw many holy places and temples of the gods.

305 The whole society of brāhmaṇas there was Vaiṣṇava in character, and all those Vaiṣṇavas read the *Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*.

306 Hearing the *Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*, the Lord was overjoyed, and He eagerly had the manuscript copied and took it with Him.

307 Nothing in the three worlds equals the *Karṇāmṛta*, for from it comes the knowledge of pure love for Kṛṣṇa.

308 Only one who constantly reads the *Karṇāmṛta* knows the furthest limit of Kṛṣṇa's beauty, sweetness and pastimes.

309 He found two manuscripts, the *Brahma-saṁhitā* and the *Karṇāmṛta*, and brought them back with great care.[43]

310 After bathing in the Tāpī He came to Māhiṣmatīpura, and there He saw many holy places on the bank of the Narmadā.

311 He saw Dhanus-tīrtha and bathed in the Nirvindhyā; then He came to the Ṛṣyamūka hill and the Daṇḍakāraṇya forest.

312 In the forest He saw the "seven palm trees" — very old, very thick and very tall.

313 Seeing the seven palms, the Lord embraced them, and they vanished in their very bodies.

314 Seeing the empty place, the people were amazed and said, "This sannyāsī is an incarnation of Rāma.

315 The palms have gone in their very bodies to the abode of Śrī Vaikuṇṭha. Who but Rāma alone has such power?"

316 The Lord came and bathed in Lake Pampā; then He came to Pañcavaṭī and rested there.

317 In Nāsika He saw Tryambaka and went on to Brahmagiri; then He came to Kuśāvarta, where the Godāvarī has its source.

318 Visiting a great many holy places, He came to Sapta-godāvarī, and from there the Lord came once again to Vidyānagara.

319 Hearing of the Lord's arrival, Rāmānanda Rāya came joyfully and met Him.

320 He fell flat in obeisance, clasping the Lord's feet, and the Lord raised him and embraced him.

321 The two of them wept in ecstatic love, and in the bliss of love their hearts were overpowered.

322 After a while the two grew calm, and sitting together, they talked at length of their Beloved.

323 The Lord told him the whole story of His pilgrimage and gave him the two manuscripts, the *Karṇāmṛta* and the *Brahma-saṁhitā*.

324 The Lord said, "These two books bear witness to that very *rasa* — the conclusions about love (*prema-siddhānta*) that you spoke to Me."

325 Rāya was overjoyed to receive the books. He relished them together with the Lord and had copies made to keep.

326 "The Gosāñi has come!" — a clamour rose in the village, and all the people came to see the Lord.

327 Seeing the crowd, Rāmānanda went home, and at midday the Lord rose to take His meal.

328 At night Rāya came again, and the two stayed awake all night talking about Kṛṣṇa.

329 Night and day the two spoke about Kṛṣṇa, and five or seven days passed in supreme bliss.

330 Rāmānanda said, “O Lord, with Your permission I have written humbly to the king.

331 The king has ordered me to go to Nīlācala, and I have begun to prepare for the journey.”

332 The Lord said, “It is for this very reason that I have come here: I shall take you with Me to Nīlācala.”

333 Rāya said, “O Lord, please go ahead to Nīlācala; with me there are elephants and horses and the clamour of soldiers.

334 In ten days or so I shall settle all this, and then I shall follow close behind You.”

335 Then Mahāprabhu told him to come later, and the Lord set out joyfully for Nīlācala.

336 The Lord went back by the same road by which He had come, seeing all the Vaiṣṇavas along the way.[44]

337 Wherever He went, the people rose up crying out “Hari!”, and seeing this, Gaurahari rejoiced at heart.

338 Coming to Ālālanātha, He sent Kṛṣṇadāsa ahead to call Nityānanda and His other associates.

339 Hearing of the Lord's arrival, Nityānanda Rāya rose and set out at once, unable to contain Himself for love.

340 Jagadānanda, Dāmodara Paṇḍita and Mukunda went along dancing; their bodies could not contain their joy.

341 Gopīnātha Ācārya went joyfully too, and they all met the Lord when they came upon Him on the road.

342 In ecstatic love the Lord embraced them all, and in ecstatic love they all wept for joy.

343 Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya also went joyfully, and coming to the shore of the ocean, he met the Lord.

344 Sārvabhauma fell at Mahāprabhu's feet, and the Lord raised him and embraced him.

345 Sārvabhauma wept in ecstatic love, and the Lord went with them all to see Jagannātha.

346 In ecstatic love He had *darśana* of Jagannātha, and His body was flooded with trembling, sweat, horripilation and tears.

347 Absorbed in love, He danced and sang at length, and all the temple servants, the *pāṇḍās* and *pālas*, came bringing garlands and *prasāda*.[45]

348 Receiving the garlands and *prasāda*, the Lord grew calm, and all the servants of Jagannātha met Him joyfully.

349 Kāśī Miśra came and fell at the Lord's feet, and the Lord honoured him with an embrace.

350 Sārvabhauma took the Lord to his own house, inviting Him with the words, "Your meal will be at my house."

351 He had a great deal of excellent *mahā-prasāda* brought — cakes, sweet drinks and all that Jagannātha had eaten.

352 The Lord performed His midday duties with His associates, then came to Sārvabhauma's house and took His meal.

353 After serving Him the meal, he had Him lie down to rest, and Sārvabhauma himself massaged His feet.

354 The Lord sent him off to take his own meal, and to please him He stayed that night in his house.

355 With Sārvabhauma and His own associates He stayed awake all night, telling the story of His pilgrimage.

356 The Lord said, "I have travelled to so many holy places, yet I have not seen a single Vaiṣṇava equal to you.

357 Rāmānanda Rāya alone gave Me great happiness." The Bhaṭṭācārya said, "That is why I asked You to meet him."

358 Thus I conclude the story of the pilgrimage. I have told it in brief; it cannot be described in full.

359 I do not know how to describe Caitanya's endless pastimes; yet out of greed I have cast off all shame and reach out for them.

360 Whoever hears the story of the Lord's pilgrimage obtains the treasure of deep love at Caitanya's feet.

361 Hear the deeds of Caitanya with faith and devotion; give up envy and say with your lips, "Hari! Hari!"

362 In this age of Kali there is no other *dharma*: this is the heart of the matter, as the Vaiṣṇavas and the Vaiṣṇava scriptures declare.[4647]

363 The pastimes of Caitanya-candra are fathomless and deep. I cannot enter them; I only touch them, standing on the shore.

364 Whoever hears the deeds of Caitanya with faith gains the treasure of love: the more he reflects on them, the more he gains.

365 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the people of the South are like Gajendra, and the crocodiles are Buddhism, Jainism, Māyāvāda and other doctrines. ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 4.2; translation as there. ↩
3. Heading in the edition: the Lord went this way and that across the South, so the author's account does not keep to the geographical order and gives only the general direction of the journey. ↩
4. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the *pāṣaṇḍīs* (unbelievers) are the *jñānīs* and the followers of *karma-vāda*, the opponents of pure devotion. ↩
5. The verse explains the name "Rāma" by its derivation: from the root *ram*, "to delight" (*ramante*, "they delight"). ↩
6. Source as in the edition: a verse of the *Mahābhārata* (Udyoga-parva, 71.4) quoted by Śrīdhara Svāmī. ↩
7. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the logicians (*tārkikas*) are the Naiyāyikas, followers of Gautama, and the Vaiśeṣikas, followers of Kaṇāda; the

Mīmāṁsakas follow Jaimini; the Māyāvādīs, Śaṅkara; Sāṅkhya is the teaching of Kapila; Pātañjala is the yoga-śāstra; the smṛtis are the twenty dharma-śāstra *saṁhitās* of Manu, Atri and others; the Purāṇas are the eighteen *mahāpurāṇas* and eighteen *upapurāṇas*; the Āgamas are the tantras. ↩

8. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: one who opposes the Vedas and has turned away from bhakti is not to be spoken with; and of one who has seen such an unbeliever the śāstra says, "let him enter the water with his clothes on." ↩
9. *Anubhāṣya*: the Buddhist śāstras do not follow the path of *śruti*, Vedic revelation, and so the Lord refutes them by logic alone. ↩
10. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Buddhists have two paths, the *hīnayāna* and the *mahāyāna*, and both start from nine tenets: the universe is beginningless and so has no Īśvara; the world is unreal; the truth is the "I"; rebirth and the other world are real; Buddha alone is the way to know the truth; *nirvāṇa* is the highest truth; Buddhist philosophy alone is true; the Vedas were composed by men; the Buddhist life is the practice of true dharma — compassion and the like. ↩
11. *Anubhāṣya* (on verse 358): instead of "having seen the goddess Bhairavī at Śiyālī" one should read "having seen Śrī Bhū-varāha at Śiyālī": near Śiyālī and Chidambaram, in the famous temple of Śrīmuṣṇam, abides the Deity of Śrī Bhū-varāhadeva, not Bhairavī-devī. The edition leaves the text of the verse unchanged. ↩
12. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Nārāyaṇa is Kṛṣṇa's form for pastimes (*vilāsa-mūrti*); He has four arms rather than two, but in His essential nature (*svarūpa*) He is not different from Kṛṣṇa. There is grace in Nārāyaṇa, but not pastimes full of artfulness (*vaidagdhya*) as in Kṛṣṇa. ↩
13. *Anubhāṣya*: in essence Nārāyaṇa and Kṛṣṇa are not different, but in rasa it is the form of Kṛṣṇa that excels; see Ādi, chapters 2 and 3, and the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*. ↩
14. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Śrutis could not enter the *rāsa* circle while they took the gopīs' mood only in the heart; when they took it both in body and in heart, they followed the gopīs and entered Kṛṣṇa's *rāsa* dance. Lakṣmī, however, prayed for Kṛṣṇa's company in her own body and did not serve Him by following the gopīs' love, and so she did not attain the *rāsa* pastimes. ↩
15. The same verse as Ādi 2.67 and Ādi 5.79; translation as there. ↩
16. The same verse as 117. ↩
17. The same verse as Ādi 17.281; translation as there. ↩
18. *Anubhāṣya*: the reality of Vaikuṇṭha cannot be measured by matter. In support it cites the *Kaṭha Upaniṣad* (2.3: "His form does not stand within the

range of sight; no one sees Him with the eyes… He cannot be reached by speech, by mind or by sight") and the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.84.13). ↩

19. *Anubhāṣya*: Durvaśana is Darbhaśayana, a temple of Śrī Rāmacandra seven miles east of Ramnad, on the seashore. ↩
20. *Anubhāṣya*: only two parts of the present *Kūrma Purāṇa* survive, the Pūrva-khaṇḍa and the Uttara-khaṇḍa; it once had seventeen thousand verses in four *saṁhitās*. ↩
21. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads «অগ্নে», "in the fire"; another reading has «অগ্নি», "Agni" (made the *māyā-Sītā* vanish). The translation follows the edition; so too in verse 212, where the shadow Sītā enters the fire. ↩
22. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Mahāprabhu brought the old leaves so that the brāhmaṇa Rāmadāsa would believe. ↩
23. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Bhaṭṭathāris (in common speech, "Bhāṭwārīs") have neither house nor home; wherever they stop, they live in simple tents. Outwardly they wear the dress of sannyāsīs, but their trade is theft and deceit; with the women they keep in their tents they lure others and so swell their band. ↩
24. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the chapter of the *Brahma-saṁhitā* is its fifth chapter, now available in Bengal with the commentary of Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī. The *Anubhāṣya* lists its subjects: inconceivable oneness and difference, the eighteen-syllable mantra, the *kāma-gāyatrī*, the form of Govinda, Gokula, the truth of the *jīva*, *prema*, devotion on the path of *rāga*, *svakīyā* and *parakīyā*, and much else. ↩
25. Heading in the edition: the Lord humbly questions the great paṇḍita Raghuvarya Tīrtha. ↩
26. *Anubhāṣya*: the *sādhana* the ācārya of the Tattvavādīs names is devotion mixed with *karma*: *varṇāśrama-dharma* offered to Kṛṣṇa. His *sādhya* is the five kinds of liberation and going to Vaikuṇṭha (257); but the *sādhana* of the scriptures Mahāprabhu revealed is hearing and chanting, and their *sādhya* is love for Kṛṣṇa (258). ↩
27. *Anubhāṣya*: this was Prahlāda's answer to his father, Hiraṇyakaśipu, who asked what he had learned from the sons of his guru. Devotion is first offered to the Lord and then performed — directly, not through *jñāna* and *karma*, and not first performed and only afterwards offered; and one who serves in this way regards pure service to Hari as the fruit of studying all the scriptures. ↩
28. *Anubhāṣya*: these words were spoken by Kavi, one of the nine Yogendras, to King Nimi. *Evaṁ-vrataḥ* — one whose vow is the service of hearing,

chanting and the like; *druta-cittaḥ* — with a heart full of longing; *loka-bāhyaḥ* — indifferent to people's laughter, blame or praise. ↩

29. The same verse as Ādi 7.94; translation as there. ↩
30. *Anubhāṣya* (on Madhya 8.62): the Lord's answer to Uddhava about the marks of the sādhu dear to Him; "his duties" are the worldly dharmas of the varṇas and āśramas, which the Lord enjoins as the teacher of Vedic karma. ↩
31. The same verse as Madhya 8.62; translation as there. ↩
32. The same verse as Madhya 8.63; translation as there. ↩
33. *Anubhāṣya*: this is Śrī Bhagavān's answer to Uddhava, who asked who must perform *karma* and who may give it up. Weariness (*nirveda*) is detachment from all talk other than talk of Kṛṣṇa; *karma* here means the regular and occasional duties (*nitya-* and *naimittika-karma*). ↩
34. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* (on Ādi 4.207): *sālokya* — residence in Vaikuṇṭha, *sārṣṭi* — opulence, *sāmīpya* — nearness, *sārūpya* — a four-armed form, oneness — *sāyujya*, merging; the devotees do not accept them, for apart from transcendental service to the Lord they have nothing to desire. ↩
35. The same verse as Ādi 4.207; translation as there. ↩
36. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: if even liberation, *nirvāṇa*, is worthless to such sādhus, what to speak of earthly happiness. ↩
37. *Anubhāṣya*: Śambhu (Śiva) spoke these words to Pārvatī when she had cursed Citraketu and he had humbly accepted the curse. Fear arises from absorption in a "second thing" — in *māyā*, perceived as something other than Kṛṣṇa; for the pure devotee heaven, hell and *mokṣa* are all such a "second thing", foreign to the soul and therefore not dear to him. ↩
38. *Anubhāṣya*: from the line of gurus of the Uttararāḍhī Maṭha it is known that in Śrī Mahāprabhu's time its head was Śrī Raghuvarya Tīrtha (here the edition has "Raghuvīrya"). ↩
39. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the conclusions of this *sampradāya* are for the most part opposed to pure devotion, yet it has one great merit — it accepts the true and eternal form (*vigraha*) of the Lord. Relying on this principal conclusion, Mahāprabhu's *parama-guru*, Śrī Mādhavendra Purī, accepted the Madhva *sampradāya*. ↩
40. *Anubhāṣya*: *tāṁra ghare* means "him": in colloquial Bengali *ghare* after a pronoun in the genitive serves as the accusative. It is the pride of the ācārya himself. ↩
41. *Anubhāṣya*: only from Śrīla Mādhavendra Purī did love for Kṛṣṇa in the mood of separation (*vipralambha*), rooted in exclusive service to Śrī Rādhā, descend into the world: he is "the first sprout of the wish-fulfilling tree of

devotion" (Ādi 9.10). Only one bound to him by ties dear to him has a claim to this love. ↩

42. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Śaṅkarāraṇya Svāmī was Mahāprabhu's elder brother, Śrīmad Viśvarūpa; in his wanderings he attained perfection (*siddhi*) at Pāṇḍarapura, that is, he entered the spiritual abode. ↩
43. The first line is the same as Madhya 1.120. ↩
44. Heading in the edition: to show mercy to the devotees who had become Vaiṣṇavas, the Lord goes back by the same road. ↩
45. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the *pāṇḍās* perform the worship of Śrī Jagannātha, and the "*paśupālas*" render other services; from the two words together comes "*pāṇḍāpāla*". ↩
46. *Anubhāṣya*: the essence the Vaiṣṇavas and all the Vaiṣṇava scriptures convey is this: for a pure *jīva*, free from envy, the one eternal *dharma* in the age of Kali is to take shelter at Śrī Gaura's feet and chant the holy name. The Vaiṣṇava is the experience of the wise (*vidvad-anubhava*), the Vaiṣṇava scripture is the evidence of revelation (*śabda-pramāṇa*); to follow both is to walk the path of *śrauta*. ↩
47. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: apart from this there is no other *dharma* in the age of Kali; to serve the pure Vaiṣṇavas and read the scriptures of the pure Vaiṣṇavas is the one *dharma* of the *jīva*. ↩